# Mathias Fonseca

Senior Staff Engineer, Fintech · Solutions Architect

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15+ Years Experience | 50+ PSP Integrations | $40B GMV Scale | 100+ People Led | 20+ Teams Built

## SUMMARY

Senior Staff Engineer in Fintech at Wolt — part of DoorDash's global Money organisation spanning Wolt, Deliveroo, and DoorDash. 15+ years building payment systems at scale across Latin America, Europe, the Middle East, and Asia: founding engineer at Payrails, and earlier scaled Delivery Hero's Global Fintech team from 3 to 100+ people powering $40B annual GMV. Alongside the payments work, I drive how the engineering org adopts AI — raising developer velocity and pushing toward genuinely AI-native engineering. 7 years a Software Architecture professor; conference speaker.

## EXPERIENCE

### Wolt + DoorDash

Berlin, Germany

**Senior Staff Engineer, Fintech** — May 2026 – Present

- Technical direction for the international Money platform — payments, payouts, lending, card issuing, and gift cards spanning Wolt, Deliveroo, and DoorDash across Europe, the Middle East, Asia, and the Americas
- Helping bring the three companies' financial solutions onto common ground as they consolidate — the same work I did building Delivery Hero's global fintech and helping merchants consolidate at Payrails
- Driving AI adoption and developer velocity across the org; AI Ambassador moving teams from AI-assisted to genuinely AI-native ways of working, and defining how we evaluate AI-built systems
- Shaping long-term technical direction across teams through architecture docs, prototypes, and RFCs

### Payrails

Berlin, Germany

**Founding Engineer · Solutions Architect & Principal Engineer** — Dec 2021 – Dec 2025

- First employee — designed and built the company's core technical architecture from scratch, now powering enterprise merchants' entire payment stack
- Grew the company to 100+ people across 9 teams (Berlin & Cairo); collaborated across product, tech, GTM, sales, and customer success
- Drove merchant success from zero to first 15 enterprise clients: onboarding, critical issue resolution, and process improvement
- Supported sales pipeline with technical demos, RFPs, and solution design for enterprise prospects
- Maintained the core architecture blueprint and led key technical decisions via RFC-driven processes

### Delivery Hero

Berlin, Germany

**Global Fintech Principal Engineer** — Oct 2020 – Dec 2021

- Helped grow Global Fintech from 3 to 100+ people across 8 specialised teams (Payments, Risk, Compliance, Wallet, Payouts, Integrations, Analytics, Business)
- Provided architectural guidance across 50+ countries powering $40B in annual GMV
- Cross-functional consultant: payments and fraud system design across Delivery Hero's global footprint
- Bridged engineering, product, and compliance to ensure consistency, scalability, and regulatory alignment

**Global Payments Senior Engineering Manager** — May 2019 – Oct 2020

- Built the Global Fintech team from scratch at Delivery Hero HQ
- Designed scalable payment solutions across diverse market requirements; expanded to new payment methods
- Led cross-functional teams on fraud prevention, compliance, and checkout optimisation

### PedidosYa

Montevideo, Uruguay

**Shopping Tribe Technical Leader** — Jan 2019 – Apr 2019

- Led 5 teams (~30 engineers) across Ordering, Checkout, Payments, and Fraud for Latin America's #1 food delivery platform — 15 countries, $2.5B+ GMV
- Ensured architectural consistency across platforms and markets; aligned with Product and stakeholders

**Payments & Fraud Prevention Engineering Manager** — Sep 2016 – Apr 2019

- Led the Payments and Fraud Prevention Squad — set OKRs, planned projects, negotiated with PSPs, balanced stakeholder interests
- Continued as full-stack engineer and API designer across payment integration and fraud prevention systems

**Senior Full Stack Engineer** Oct 2013 – Sep 2016

- One of the first engineers — built the platform from scratch, expanding across 12+ countries
- Developed deep expertise in payment systems and fraud prevention in one of the world's highest-fraud markets

## Universidad ORT Uruguay

Montevideo, Uruguay

**Software Architecture Professor** Aug 2012 – Apr 2019

- 7 years teaching Software Architecture for BSc Software Engineering and Computer Science; Architectural Patterns, Quality Attributes, Tactics with Java EE

**Software Engineering in the Cloud Professor** Jul 2014 – Sep 2015

- Advanced course on cloud architecture, Web APIs, and deployment strategies

## EARLIER EXPERIENCE

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|---|---|---|
| **Softruck** — CTO | Belo Horizonte, Brazil | Sep–Dec 2015 |
| **MercadoLibre** — Software Engineer | Montevideo, Uruguay | May–Oct 2013 |
| **Tata Consultancy Services** — Business Analyst & .NET Developer | Montevideo, Uruguay | 2010–2013 |
| **TECHO** — IT Manager / Volunteer (anti-poverty NGO) | Montevideo, Uruguay | 2008–2011 |

## SKILLS & DOMAIN EXPERTISE

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| **Languages** | Java · Kotlin · Go · Groovy · Python · TypeScript · React |
| **Infrastructure** | AWS · Docker · Kubernetes · Terraform |
| **Data** | PostgreSQL · Redis · Kafka · BigQuery |
| **Payments Domain** | 50+ PSP integrations · Orchestration · Fraud prevention · Chargebacks · Payouts |
| **Compliance** | PCI-DSS · GDPR · SCA / PSD2 / Open Banking · AML/KYC · ISO 27001 |
| **Architecture** | Domain-Driven Design · Event-driven architecture · RFC-driven decisions · Distributed systems |
| **AI & Dev Productivity** | AI-native engineering · Developer velocity · Applied LLMs · Agentic workflows · AI adoption |
| **Leadership** | Cross-functional team leadership · OKRs · Technical strategy · Mentorship · Solutions architecture |
| **Human Languages** | Spanish (Native) · English (Fluent) · Portuguese (Professional) · German (B1) · Italian (Elementary) |

## EDUCATION

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|---|---|
| Big Data & Machine Learning Specialization | Universidad ORT Uruguay · 2018–2020 |
| BSc in Information Technology | Universidad ORT Uruguay · 2008–2012 |

## SELECTED TALKS & PUBLICATIONS

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|---|---|
| [Conference Talk] Payments Engineering and Stoicism | QuantumTech 2021 |
| [Conference Panel] Payments in the Sharing Economy | PAYMENTSfn 2019 |
| [Article] Mastering PSP Integrations | mathifonseca.me |
| [Article] A Survival Guide for Payments | mathifonseca.me |
| [Case Study] PedidosYa Payment Infrastructure | Spreedly |
| [Podcast] Payments and Delivery in Latin America | LATAM payments series |